consistent reads. Strongly consistent reads are supported by `getItem`, `query`, and `scan` operations. But a strongly consistent read is more expensive—it takes longer and consumes more read capacity—than an eventually consistent read. Reads from a global secondary index are always eventually consistent because the synchronization between table and index happens asynchronously.

Typically, NoSQL databases do not support transactions with atomicity, consistency, isolation, and durability (ACID) guarantees. However, DynamoDB comes with the ability to bundle multiple read or write requests into a transaction. The relevant API methods are called `TransactWriteItems` and `TransactGetItems`—you can either group write or read requests, but not a mix of both of them. Whenever possible, you should avoid using transactions because they are more expensive from a cost and latency perspective. Check out http://mng.bz/E0ol if you are interested in the details about DynamoDB transactions.

12.5 Removing data

John stumbled across a fancy to-do application on the web. Therefore, he decides to remove his user from nodetodo.

Like the `getItem` operation, the `deleteItem` operation requires that you specify the primary key you want to delete. Depending on whether your table uses a partition key or a partition key and sort key, you must specify one or two attributes. The next listing shows the implementation of the `user-rm` command.

Listing 12.15 nodetodo: Removing a user (index.js)